

Part 1, Act I, Scene 1

Harry Potter, Ginny Weasley-Potter, and their three children arrive at King's Cross station. The children are James, Albus Severus, and Lily. James starts teasing Albus about the possibility of him being sorted into Slytherin house at Hogwarts, which worries Albus. The family passes through the magical barrier into platform nine and three-quarters.

Part 1, Act I, Scene 2

The Potters meet the Granger-Weasley family, which includes Ron, Hermione, and their children Rose and Hugo. Albus confides in Harry about his concerns regarding being sorted into Slytherin, as he associates the house with Dark Magic. Harry reminds Albus that he was named after two headmasters of Hogwarts, one of whom was a Slytherin and a brave man. Harry reassures Albus that the Sorting Hat takes a person's feelings into account. This is something Harry has never told anyone else before. The parents see James, Albus, and Rose off onto the Hogwarts Express and leave quickly due to people staring at them.

Part 1, Act I, Scene 3

On the Hogwarts Express, Rose tells Albus that they need to focus on choosing their friends, just like their parents did on their first train ride to school. Albus finds the idea of having to choose "friends for life" intimidating, but Rose is excited because their famous parents will give them many options. Albus and Rose enter a compartment where they meet Scorpius Malfoy. Albus is friendly towards Scorpius, but Rose is not because Scorpius's parents had a difficult relationship with her parents. Scorpius confesses that there is a rumor about him being Voldemort's illegitimate son conceived with a Time-Turner, although he denies it. Rose decides to find another compartment, but Albus chooses to stay with Scorpius, which angers Rose. The boys share Scorpius's stash of sweets.

Part 1, Act I, Scene 4

In the Great Hall at Hogwarts, Rose is sorted into Gryffindor, while Scorpius and Albus are sorted into Slytherin, surprising everyone. During a flying lesson, Rose displays natural talent, while Albus performs poorly and becomes the subject of mockery from his classmates. Before their second year at Hogwarts, Albus asks Harry to stand apart from him because he believes himself to be a disappointing son and dislikes being stared at.

Draco Malfoy approaches Harry and asks him to address the rumors about Scorpius's parentage by confirming that all the Time-Turners were destroyed during the Battle of the Department of Mysteries, but Harry advises Draco to ignore the rumors. On the train, Rose distances herself from Albus as soon as Scorpius approaches, and their friendship becomes a pretense only in front of their parents. Back in the Great Hall, Rose is announced as the newest member of the Gryffindor Quidditch team, and Scorpius applauds her. In a Potions lesson, Albus makes a mistake with a potion, leading to jeers from his classmates.

Once again at platform nine and three-quarters, Albus burns his permission slip to visit Hogsmeade, expressing his hatred for any place with Hogwarts students. Harry expresses concern over reports of Albus's isolation and surly behavior at school, but Albus dismisses these concerns and runs off to meet Scorpius. Scorpius informs Albus that his mother has passed away and asks Albus to attend the funeral and be his good friend. In the Great Hall, Lily is sorted into Gryffindor, disappointing Albus, but Scorpius is not surprised and comments that Potters don't belong in Slytherin. Albus asserts that he does belong in Slytherin and responds to the laughter of other students by stating that he didn't choose to be Harry Potter's son.

Part 1, Act I, Scene 5

Harry arrives at the Ministry of Magic office, where Hermione is waiting for him. Harry shows Hermione an illegal Time-Turner that was seized from a Death-Eater named Theodore Nott, a former follower of Voldemort. Harry questions why Hermione is in his office, and she mildly scolds him for leaving paperwork pending as the Head of Magical Law Enforcement. As the Minister for Magic, she nudges him to complete his work. They discuss their children and express the feeling of falling short in parenting due to their busy Ministry jobs. Harry asks Hermione if the Time-Turner's existence could mean something, and she confirms that it's possible. They both agree that if there is a threat, they will find a way to fight it as they always have.

Part 1, Act I, Scene 6

Albus is hidden on the stairs at his house and overhears a conversation. Amos Diggory, a wheelchair-bound wizard, has come to visit Harry. Amos heard rumors about the Ministry finding a Time-Turner, and he asks Harry to use it to bring back his deceased son, Cedric, whom he blames Harry for. Harry denies the rumors and apologizes for being unable to help Amos.

While eavesdropping, Albus is startled by Delphi Diggory, Amos's niece and caretaker, who discovers him on the stairs. They engage in a conversation, and Delphi invites Albus to visit her at the old-age home where she lives with Amos. She leaves to take Amos home, and as Amos leaves, he calls Harry a "stone-cold Ministry man."